The Launch Checklist

Ready, Fire, Aim · From the real VibePicks build: a website, a newsletter and a working checkout, up and running with AI in one afternoon by a machinist with little coding experience, then fine-tuned along the way. Fire fast on what you can fix later. Aim carefully on payments, facts and trust.

1 Pick a niche

- [ ] Pick something you already know better than most people
- [ ] Write one sentence: "[Site] helps [who] [do what]."
- [ ] Pick a short name you can say out loud and spell on the phone

2 Get a domain

- [ ] Buy a .com if you can (about $11/year). Check the renewal price
- [ ] Buy it where you'll host if possible, to keep DNS simple
- [ ] Plan a sending address like news@yourdomain.com

3 Have AI build a static site

- [ ] First build prompt: plain HTML/CSS/JS, no database, one data file for content
- [ ] Ask for page titles, descriptions, sitemap.xml and robots.txt
- [ ] Ask for a list of every file and what it does
- [ ] Rewrite the words in your own voice, no hype
- [ ] Check every page on your phone
- [ ] Add a site icon (favicon)

4 Put it online (GitHub + Vercel)

- [ ] Private GitHub repo, no keys or passwords in it
- [ ] Repo connected to Vercel, deploys on its own
- [ ] Domain added in Vercel, DNS set, https working
- [ ] Made one harmless test change and watched it go live
- [ ] Know how to roll back to the last good version

5 Email signup (Resend)

- [ ] Signup box saves contacts to a Resend segment
- [ ] Done through a small /api/subscribe function
- [ ] Resend API key only in Vercel Environment Variables
- [ ] Hidden honeypot field to stop bots
- [ ] Sending domain verified in Resend
- [ ] Decided on purpose: open/click tracking on or off
- [ ] Tested: real email, duplicate, bad email, phone

6 Newsletter #1

- [ ] Short hello: who you are and why you started
- [ ] Every news item has a date and an official source link
- [ ] Fact-checked every claim, number and link
- [ ] Unsubscribe link works
- [ ] Sent a test to yourself and clicked every link
- [ ] Plain subject line, no clickbait
- [ ] Sent, and wrote down the delivery numbers

7 Tell people (Facebook)

- [ ] Written in your own words first, AI only tightens it
- [ ] Who you are, why you built it, what it does, what to do next
- [ ] Clicked the link in the post yourself
- [ ] Answered every comment that day

8 Working checkout (Stripe)

- [ ] Two or three clear options with prices
- [ ] Rules: sponsored spots labeled, paying never changes rankings
- [ ] Payment Links tested in Stripe test mode with a test card
- [ ] Live links swapped in; thank-you message shows after paying
- [ ] No Stripe secret keys pasted into any chat

9 Affiliates, honestly

- [ ] Only for tools you'd recommend anyway; rankings don't move
- [ ] Email pasted, not typed, on every application
- [ ] "Affiliate link" label next to every affiliate link
- [ ] rel="sponsored" on affiliate links
- [ ] Plain-English disclosure on your sponsor/about page
- [ ] Clicked every tracking link (phone too) and it landed on the right page

10 Keep it running

- [ ] Hosting plan fits your site (Vercel has a free tier; Pro, $20/mo, is for commercial sites)
- [ ] Weekly newsletter on the calendar
- [ ] Regular check of links and prices against official pages
- [ ] Simple analytics on: visits, signups
- [ ] Fix loop: what I did, what happened, what I expected

> **Ready, fire, aim.** Get it online, look at the live site yourself, fix it as you go. If a machinist from Pelkie can do it, so can you. *Chris*